THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, BEING AWARE of the ecological, social, cult
ural, economic and scientific attributes of the south-west Coral Sea, as well as its vul
nerability to damage by international shipping activities and the steps taken by the Gov
ernment of Australia to address that vulnerability, NOTING the Revised guidelines for th
e Identification and Designation of Particularly Sensitive Sea Areas (PSSA Guidelines),
adopted by the Assembly by resolution A.982(24), and the Revised Guidance Document for s
ubmission of PSSA proposals to IMO (MEPC.1/Circ.510), RECALLING resolution MEPC.133(53),
by which the Torres Strait (TS) was designated as - Revised Guidance Document for submis
sion of PSSA proposals to IMO (MEPC.1/Circ.510), RECALLING resolution MEPC.133(53), by w
hich the Torres Strait (TS) was designated as an extension of the Great Barrier Reef (GB
R) Particularly Sensitive Sea Area (PSSA), HAVING CONSIDERED the proposal made by the Go
vernment of Australia to extend the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of th
e Coral Sea, HAVING AGREED, at its sixty-eighth session, that the criteria for the ident
ification and designation of a PSSA provided in resolution A.982(24) are fulfilled for t
he extension of the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea, HAV
ING NOTED that the Sub-Committee on Navigation, Communications and Search and Rescue (NC
SR), at its second session, approved the establishment of two 5 nautical mile wide two-w
ay routes and a new area to be avoided in the south-west Coral Sea as associated protect
ive measures for the application to extend the GBR and TS PSSA to include the south-west
part of the Coral Sea to improve the safety of navigation and the protection of the mari
ne environment, - associated protective measures for the application to extend the GBR a
nd TS PSSA to include the south-west part of the Coral Sea to improve the safety of navi
gation and the protection of the marine environment, 1 DESIGNATES the south-west part of
the Coral Sea, as defined in annex 1 to the present resolution, as an extension of the G
reat Barrier Reef and Torres Strait PSSA pending the final adoption of the associated pr
otective measures for the PSSA, as set out in annex 1 of document NCSR 2/23; 2 INVITES M
ember Governments to recognize the ecological, social, cultural , economic and scientifi
c attributes of the Coral Sea area, set forth in annex 2 to the present resolution, as w
ell as its vulnerability to damage by international shipping activities, as described in
annex 3 to the present resolution; 3 FURTHER INVITES Member Governm